> the hospitals and babies in their cradles. You will randomly bomb everything from the air, killing indiscriminately, even when you are told to stop, you will immorally accuse us of being anti-Semitic. No one is swallowing it anymore.[16]

Erdoğan—at the time Turkish Prime Minister and in the final week of the presidential election campaign—charged Israel with willfully killing Palestinian mothers and cautioned that it would "drown in the blood it sheds." Speaking before thousands of cheering supporters at an Istanbul election rally, Erdoğan once more compared Israeli actions to those of Hitler.

> Just like Hitler, who sought to establish a race free of all faults, Israel is chasing after the same target. . . . They kill women so that they will not give birth to Palestinians; they kill babies so that they won't grow up; they kill men so they can't defend their country. . . . They will drown in the blood they shed.[17]

The political situation between Israel and Turkey was so tense during the Operation that there were calls for a second *Mavi Marmara* flotilla, this time with a possible Turkish Navy escort.[18] It is important to note that the clash between Israel and Turkey that led to a flood of antisemitic rhetoric had initially emerged in the wake of the first *Mavi Marmara* flotilla. This time, the political situation created the possibility of a second Mavi Marmara.

There was open incitement to anti-Jewish violence. Tweets called for burning down synagogues and even factories owned by Jews. There were repeated references to Jewish locations which virtually amounted to encouragement to attack them in their own protected residences.

Such open appeals to harm Jews were not only disseminated through social networks. They also appeared in newspapers: Faruk Köse, in an article in *Yeni Akit* threatened the Turkish Jewish community.[19] Abraham Foxman, national director of the ADL wrote to Erdoğan, asking him to "publicly reject all expressions of anti-Semitism including the scapegoating of Turkish Jews for the actions of Israel,"[20] citing examples of antisemitic expressions, including the example of Faruk Köse's article.[21] Köse had also suggested that Turkey's Jewish businessmen pay a special tax for the rehabilitation of Gaza.[22] Bülent Yıldırım, head of the IHH (the NGO behind the *Mavi Marmara* flotilla), added his own antisemitic threat: "[T]his Turkish Jewish community must immediately stop Israel's rotten behavior, otherwise, the people who live here will witness unwanted outcomes."[23] If previously a non-Zionist Jew could be accepted and considered "a Turk" in the eyes of society, this time, every Jew seemed to be a potential target.[24]

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